

Shannon Shepherd

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CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Built the feature store that 8 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.
- Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 20% across 50 regions.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Applied Scientist, Nova Tech Group

Sep 2017 – Jan 2026

- Lifted recommendation click-through by 70% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in MLflow.
- Trained and deployed Databricks models serving 15M predictions per day at under 40ms p95.
- Mentored 40 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.

Data Scientist

Beacon Interactive | Jan 2014 – Sep 2017

- Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 4 silent regressions before release.
- Cut inference cost by 12% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Grafana.

Junior Data Scientist

Vantage Analytics | Aug 2012 – Aug 2013

- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 45%.

AI Researcher

Cobalt Systems | Oct 2011 – May 2012

- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.

QUALIFICATIONS

Master, Communications

Westfield State University | 2011

Bachelor, Economics

Pinehurst University | 2005 – 2009

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Databricks — Expert

MLflow — Advanced

PyTorch — Working knowledge

Snowflake — Expert

Spark — Expert

Hugging Face — Proficient

BigQuery — Expert

Python — Intermediate

TensorFlow — Expert

Grafana — Expert

TypeScript — Intermediate

LangChain — Expert

Redshift — Proficient

Selenium — Working knowledge

NOTABLE PROJECTS

Grafana utility library

Open-source helper library for Grafana, ~300 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

Conference talk

Spoke on Grafana in production at a regional meetup, ~40 attendees.

RECOGNITION

Internal Hackathon Winner, 2016

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Volunteer instructor at a weekend coding club for 12 secondary school students.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – C2

Japanese – Professional working proficiency

Arabic – Conversational